

1. Are you emotionally intelligent? How do you say so?

Emotional intelligence is the ability to recognize, understand, manage, and use emotions effectively, both in oneself and in relationships with others. Being emotionally intelligent means being in touch with your emotions, knowing how to manage them appropriately, and empathizing with the feelings of those around you. Reflecting on whether I am emotionally intelligent involves assessing my self-awareness, empathy, and self-regulation. I believe that I possess self-awareness, as I can usually identify my emotions and understand their causes. For example, when I feel stressed, I recognize what triggers it and take steps to manage my reaction. I also value empathy, as I often try to understand others' feelings and perspectives, this helps me communicate and connect with people more effectively. While there's always room to grow, these few qualities suggest I possess emotional intelligence.

2. Why is it important to manage our own emotions?

Managing our emotions is crucial, if I am to relate it towards my path as a first year college student, it directly affects our ability to succeed and thrive in a new, often challenging environment. College life introduces us to new responsibilities, deadlines, social circles, and pressures that can easily become overwhelming if we don't handle our emotions effectively, and I believe that learning to manage emotions helps us stay focused, build positive relationships, and make better decisions. Furthermore, effective emotion management also strengthens our relationships. When we understand and regulate our feelings, we're less likely to act impulsively or let anger or frustration harm our surroundings. Being emotionally controlled makes it easier to communicate well, empathize, and build strong connections with others.

3. What triggers you mostly to become:

3.1. happy;

Happiness comes in many forms, but for me, it is often triggered by the simple joy of being around my cats. Their playful, affectionate, and sometimes mischievous behavior always lifts my spirits and makes me still feel relaxed. My cats bring out a natural sense of joy and companionship that feels effortless. They don't judge or expect anything in return; they simply enjoy being near me, which makes me feel such value. In many ways, my cats remind me to live in the moment and appreciate the small, simple things in life.

3.2. sad;

Failing at something I've worked hard on often triggers deep sadness for me. Whether it's an academic test, a personal goal, or any other endeavor I've invested time and energy into, failing can feel discouraging and even overwhelming. I believe this sadness stems from the high expectations I set for myself and the disappointment of not meeting them, failing reminds me of how unpredictable life can be and how, despite my best efforts, things don't always go as planned. These moments of sadness can be

hard to manage, as they make me question my abilities and sometimes lessen my confidence. However, while failure can trigger sadness, I've also learned that it's an essential part of growth.

3.3. anxious?

One of the biggest sources of my anxiety is the thought of not being prepared enough. When I know that my performance matters, I tend to overthink every detail, worrying that something will go wrong or that I'll forget something important. When I don't feel really prepared, I start doubting my abilities and second-guessing every decision I make. My mind replays possible scenarios where things don't go as planned, making me feel more insecure. This overthinking often leads to sleepless nights and a loss of focus, which only makes the anxiety worse. It's like a cycle where the more I worry, the harder it becomes to actually focus and prepare effectively.

4. What tips could you share for someone who is dealing with anxiety?

Managing anxiety can be easier with a few simple strategies. Deep breathing helps calm the mind and body, while staying in the present moment prevents excessive worrying about the future. Preparing is important, but it's key not to overdo it or expect perfection. Challenging negative thoughts by focusing on realistic outcomes can reduce anxiety, and taking small breaks allows for mental reset. By practicing these steps, you can better manage anxiety and feel more in control and at ease. It's important to prepare for challenges, but it's equally crucial to avoid putting too much pressure on yourself. Preparing well is about doing your best, not achieving perfection. Recognizing that mistakes and imperfections are part of life can ease anxiety. Additionally, taking small breaks during stressful moments can also help, even a few minutes away from a task can clear your mind and reduce stress. Engaging in a calming activity, like listening to music or going for a walk, can help reset your emotions.

5. Which do you prefer: emotionally intelligent or socially intelligent?

Both emotional intelligence and social intelligence are important, but if I had to choose, I would prefer emotional intelligence. Emotional intelligence involves understanding and managing my own emotions as well as empathizing with others. This skill is essential for personal growth and mental well-being. When I am emotionally intelligent, I can handle stress, make better decisions, and connect with others on a deeper level. But I believe, emotional intelligence contributes to building stronger, more authentic relationships and enables me to better handle life's ups and downs. In a world that often prioritizes social success, for me— emotional intelligence provides the inner strength and awareness needed to thrive both personally and socially.